SAT Reading and Writing: Tutor Panel

This set mixes official College Board questions with new questions we wrote to the same specifications. How many of each is not fixed, so judge every question on its own. It takes about two hours; Part 2 starts at question 44, so you can do it in two sittings.

1. **Official or new:** 1 means you are sure it is an official College Board question, 5 that you are sure it is new, 3 that you cannot tell.
2. **Seen before:** tick it if you remember this exact question from the College Board question bank, Bluebook or any prep material.
3. **Why:** one line on what decided it (topic, wording, answer choices, difficulty, anything). This is the most useful part.

Formatting has been made the same for every question, so ignore layout, and ignore small typos that look like copying errors: judge the question itself. Please do not look questions up online or discuss them until you have finished. The key for each question is shown next to its number. You can fill this PDF in on screen: click the boxes (tick one rating), type in the Why line, then save the file and send it back. If you print it instead, copy your answers into the answer grid on the last pages and send a photo.

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1 Central Ideas and Details · Hard Key: C

Some animal-behavior studies involve observing wild animals in their natural habitat, and some involve capturing wild animals and observing them in a laboratory. Each approach has advantages over the other. In wild studies, researchers can more easily presume that the animals are behaving normally, and in lab studies, researchers can more easily control factors that might affect the results. But if, for example, the results from a wild study and a lab study of Western scrub-jays (Aphelocoma californica) contradict each other, one or both of the studies must have failed to account for some factor that was relevant to the birds' behavior.

Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

A) When the results of a natural-habitat study and those from a lab study of a wild animal such as the Western scrub-jay conflict, the study in the natural habitat is more likely than the lab study to have accurate results.

B) Studying wild animals such as the Western scrub-jay in both their natural habitat and lab settings is likely to yield conflicting results that researchers cannot fully resolve.

C) Wild animals such as the Western scrub-jay can be effectively studied in their natural habitat and in the lab, but each approach has drawbacks that could affect the accuracy of the findings.

D) Differing results between natural-habitat and lab studies of wild animals such as the Western scrub-jay are a strong indication that both of the studies had design flaws that affected the accuracy of their results.

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐ Seen before

Why:

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2 Words in Context · Easy Key: D

Cucurbits, a group of plants that includes squash and melons, relied on mastodons to spread their seeds in the Ice Age. When these animals died out, cucurbits faced extinction in turn, having lost their means of seed dispersal. Around this time, however, the ancestors of Indigenous peoples in North America began raising cucurbits as crops, thus _____ the plants' survival.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A) verifying

B) multiplying

C) comforting

D) ensuring

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐ Seen before

Why:

3 Form, Structure, and Sense · Easy Key: A

American composer Gabriela Lena Frank often draws on her mother's Peruvian heritage. Her string quartet Leyendas: An Andean Walkabout, completed in 2001, _____ the distinctive timbres of traditional Andean instruments, such as panpipes and the tarka, a wooden flute that is blown harshly to split its tone.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A) imitates

B) imitate

C) are imitating

D) have imitated

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐ Seen before

Why:

4 Text Structure and Purpose · Medium Key: D

Metamaterials, structures whose unusual physical properties arise from the arrangement of many tiny elements rather than from the materials they are made of, are rare in nature, and until recently no acoustic example was known. Biologist Thomas Neil and colleagues have found that the scale layer on moths' wings is one: each scale acts as a resonator tuned to a specific frequency, and because the scales are coupled through the wing membrane, together they absorb ultrasound across the full range of frequencies that bats use in echolocation. This acoustic camouflage is achieved with a layer thin and light enough for flight.

Which choice best describes the function of the underlined portion in the text as a whole?

A) It describes the procedure the researchers followed to measure how much ultrasound moth wings absorb.

B) It qualifies the previous sentence's claim that acoustic metamaterials are rare in nature.

C) It explains why bats have been unable to adjust their calls to detect moths in flight.

D) It explains how moths' wing scales function together as an acoustic metamaterial.

Official ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5 **New** ☐ Seen before

Why:

5 Cross-Text Connections · Easy Key: B

Text 1

Parents and teachers often assume that a toddler's play benefits from abundance. A playroom stocked with blocks, puzzles, toy trucks, and pretend-play sets, the reasoning goes, offers far more chances to explore than a sparsely furnished one. If so, surrounding young children with a large and varied collection of toys should be one of the best ways to encourage long, imaginative play.

Text 2

Occupational therapy researchers at the University of Toledo observed 36 toddlers aged 18 to 30 months during two supervised play sessions: one in a room with four toys and one in a room with sixteen. With fewer toys available, the children switched from toy to toy less often. They also played with each toy for longer periods and used each one in a greater variety of ways.

Based on the texts, how would the researchers in Text 2 most likely respond to the assumption discussed in Text 1?

A) Toddlers offered only a few toys tend to lose interest in playing sooner than toddlers offered many.

B) An abundance of toys may actually work against the kind of focused, inventive play that it is intended to promote.

C) The kinds of toys available to toddlers influence the quality of their play more than the number of toys does.

D) Toddlers engage in more imaginative play when a parent joins in than when an adult merely supervises them.

Official ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5 **New** ☐ Seen before

Why:

6 Cross-Text Connections · Easy Key: D

Text 1

Most scientists agree that the moon was likely formed after a collision between Earth and a large planet named Theia. This collision likely created a huge debris field, made up of material from both Earth and Theia. Based on models of this event, scientists believe that the moon was formed from this debris over the course of thousands of years.

Text 2

Researchers from NASA's Ames Research Center used a computer to model how the moon could have formed. Although simulations of the moon's formation have been done in the past, the team from NASA ran simulations that were much more detailed. They found that the formation of the moon was likely not a slow process that took many years. Instead, it's probable that the moon's formation happened immediately after impact, taking just a few hours.

Which choice best describes a difference in how the author of Text 1 and the author of Text 2 view the evidence for the formation of the moon?

A) The author of Text 1 argues that the formation of the moon occurred much earlier than the author of Text 2 argues.

B) The author of Text 1 suggests there is more evidence confirming the existence of Theia than the author of Text 2 suggests.

C) The author of Text 1 claims that the moon's surface is more similar to Earth's surface than the author of Text 2 claims.

D) The author of Text 1 believes that the moon formed more slowly than the author of Text 2 believes.

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

7 Form, Structure, and Sense · Hard

Key: A

In Recollections of Things to Come (1963), Mexican writer Elena Garro portrays Ixtepec, a fictional southern town under military occupation during the Cristero War, the Catholic insurrection against Mexico's anticlerical government in the late 1920s. At once the novel's setting and its narrator, _____

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A) Ixtepec recounts in the first person its residents' suffering under the despotic General Francisco Rosas.

B) its residents' suffering under the despotic General Francisco Rosas is recounted by Ixtepec in the first person.

C) Garro has Ixtepec recount in the first person its residents' suffering under the despotic General Francisco Rosas.

D) the first-person account of its residents' suffering under the despotic General Francisco Rosas comes from Ixtepec.

Official ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5 **New** ☐ Seen before

Why:

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8 Words in Context · Medium

Key: C

Like the 1945 play it reimagines—Federico Garcia Lorca's The House of Bernarda Alba—Marcus Gardley's 2014 play The House That Will Not Stand prominently features women. In both plays, the all-female cast _____ an array of female characters, including a strong mother and several daughters dealing with individual struggles.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A) engulfs

B) encourages

C) comprises

D) provokes

Official ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5 **New** ☐ Seen before

Why:

9 Text Structure and Purpose · Easy Key: D

Navajo textile artist Melissa Cody, who grew up watching her mother and grandmother at the loom and began weaving at age five, works in what is known as the Germantown Revival style. On a traditional Navajo loom built by her father, she weaves tapestries whose vibrant colors, diamond patterns, and overlapping geometric forms seem to rise off the surface in three dimensions. Alongside traditional Navajo symbols, Cody often includes personal tributes and references to pop culture.

Which choice best describes the overall structure of the text?

A) It describes a weaving technique developed in the nineteenth century, then traces its gradual abandonment by Navajo weavers.

B) It compares the work of three generations of weavers in one family, then singles out the youngest as the most inventive.

C) It presents an artist's family history, then lists the museums that have exhibited her tapestries.

D) It introduces a weaver, then describes the distinctive features of the tapestries she creates.

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐ Seen before

Why:

10 Inferences · Medium Key: B

Red velvet cake has been a favorite dessert of many for years, but the recipe's origins are unclear. A bakery in Dallas, Texas, argued that it created the first recipe for the cake when the bakery opened in the 1860s. The Adams Extract Co., which sells baking products, claims to have created the recipe in the 1930s to help market their red dye. A US hotel and a Canadian department store also publicly stated that the red velvet cake sold in each of their establishments in the 1930s was an original creation, each alleging that it was the recipe author. No clear evidence has emerged to favor one of these claims over the others, however. It thus seems that _____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A) red velvet cake was first baked sometime before the 1860s.

B) we cannot say at present who actually baked the first red velvet cake.

C) none of the supposed inventors of red velvet cake are likely to have invented it.

D) the bakery in Dallas, Texas, probably invented red velvet cake.

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐ Seen before

Why:

11 Cross-Text Connections · Hard Key: D

Text 1

Seeds of Audouinia capitata, a threatened fynbos shrub of South Africa, germinate in the wild almost exclusively after fires, yet researcher Hannes de Lange found that heat alone was unlikely to trigger them. In the late 1980s, he burned fynbos vegetation in a barrel and piped the cooled smoke into tents covering squares of cleared ground. Seven months later, dozens of A. capitata seedlings had emerged beneath the tents and none in the surrounding soil; in 1990, de Lange and Charles Boucher identified chemical factors in smoke as the germination cue.

Text 2

Reasoning that cellulose burns in any plant fire, chemist Gavin Flematti's team analyzed cellulose-derived smoke and in 2004 isolated a butenolide that promotes germination even at concentrations below one part per billion. The compound, which they also detected in smoke from burning plant material, stimulated germination in two Australian wildflowers and a lettuce cultivar about as effectively as water infused with plant-derived smoke.

Based on the texts, if de Lange and Boucher (Text 1) and Flematti's team (Text 2) were aware of the findings of both studies, they would most likely agree with which statement?

A) The butenolide promotes the germination of fire-dependent species more effectively than heat does but less effectively than smoke itself.

B) Smoke from burning cellulose alone would probably not prompt A. capitata seeds to germinate, because cellulose is not unique to fynbos plants.

C) A. capitata seeds must be exposed to smoke for several months before the seedlings can emerge from the soil.

D) The seeds that germinated in de Lange's tents were most likely exposed to a compound that forms when cellulose burns.

Official ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5 **New** ☐ Seen before

Why:

12 Rhetorical Synthesis · Easy Key: A

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- Madagascar is home to a group of miniaturized leaf chameleons in the genus Brookesia.
- In 2021, Frank Glaw's team described a new species in this group, Brookesia nana.
- They had just two specimens, both collected in northern Madagascar.
- The male's body is only 13.5 millimeters long, not counting the tail.
- The team suggests that B. nana may be the world's smallest reptile.

The student wants to emphasize how small Brookesia nana is. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

A) With a body only 13.5 millimeters long, the male Brookesia nana may be the smallest reptile in the world.

B) Brookesia nana belongs to a group of leaf chameleons found in Madagascar.

C) Glaw's team described Brookesia nana in 2021 on the basis of just two specimens.

D) The two specimens of Brookesia nana that Glaw's team described were both collected in northern Madagascar.

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

13 Command of Evidence · Hard Key: C

In November 1918, the steamship Talune docked at Apia, the capital of New Zealand–administered Western Samoa, having sailed from Auckland, where an influenza epidemic was then raging. Although several people aboard had already fallen ill, port officials allowed the ship's passengers ashore without imposing a quarantine, and within two months influenza had killed more than 7,500 Samoans, roughly a fifth of the territory's population. Some historians assert that the scale of the catastrophe owed less to the virulence of the strain itself than to choices made by the territory's colonial officials.

Which quotation from a scholarly article best supports the assertion of the historians mentioned in the text?

A) "The strain of influenza circulating in 1918 was unusually lethal for young adults, a group that seasonal influenza rarely kills in large numbers."

B) "Island populations in the Pacific that had been relatively isolated before 1918, and so had been exposed to fewer respiratory infections, generally suffered far higher death rates in the pandemic."

C) "In nearby American Samoa, the naval governor barred travel from the neighboring islands and kept arriving passengers under observation; that territory recorded no influenza deaths."

D) "New Zealand had governed Western Samoa only since August 1914, when its troops occupied the islands, which had until then been a German colony."

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

14 Form, Structure, and Sense · Medium

Key: A

The Proto-Nilotic language, common ancestor of fifty-five African languages with similar linguistic properties, _____ like all protolanguages, hypothetical: there's no direct evidence these ancestral languages actually existed.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A) is,

B) are,

C) have been,

D) were,

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

15 Boundaries · Hard

Key: B

The field of geological oceanography owes much to American _____ Marie Tharp, a pioneering oceanographic cartographer whose detailed topographical maps of the ocean floor and its multiple rift valleys helped garner acceptance for the theories of plate tectonics and continental drift.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A) geologist,

B) geologist

C) geologist;

D) geologist:

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

16 Rhetorical Synthesis · Hard Key: D

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- One of history's greatest libraries was the House of Wisdom in Baghdad, Iraq.
- It was founded in the eighth century with the goal of preserving all the world's knowledge.
- Scholars at the House of Wisdom collected ancient and contemporary texts from Greece, India, and elsewhere and translated them into Arabic.
- Writings included those of the Greek philosopher Aristotle and the Indian mathematician Aryabhata.
- The House of Wisdom used Chinese papermaking technology to create paper versions to be studied and shared.

The student wants to explain how the House of Wisdom preserved the world's knowledge. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

A) The House of Wisdom was known for bringing together knowledge from around the world, including from Greece, India, and China.

B) Founded in Iraq in the eighth century, the House of Wisdom employed many scholars as translators.

C) Writings from the Greek philosopher Aristotle and the Indian mathematician Aryabhata were preserved at the House of Wisdom.

D) The House of Wisdom collected writings from different countries and created paper versions in Arabic to be studied and shared.

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

17 Text Structure and Purpose · Medium Key: D

The following text is from Herman Melville's 1854 novel The Lightning-rod Man.

The stranger still stood in the exact middle of the cottage, where he had first planted himself. <u>His singularity impelled a closer scrutiny.</u> A lean, gloomy figure. Hair dark and lank, mattedly streaked over his brow. His sunken pitfalls of eyes were ringed by indigo halos, and played with an innocuous sort of lightning: the gleam without the bolt. The whole man was dripping. He stood in a puddle on the bare oak floor: his strange walking-stick vertically resting at his side.

Which choice best states the function of the underlined sentence in the overall structure of the text?

A) It elaborates on the previous sentence's description of the character.

B) It introduces the setting that is described in the sentences that follow.

C) It establishes a contrast with the description in the previous sentence.

D) It sets up the character description presented in the sentences that follow.

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

18 Transitions · Hard Key: C

Modernista architects championed nature in their designs. _____ the wavy staircase and ornate floral tilework of Hospital de Sant Pau, a Modernista hospital designed by Lluís Domènech i Montaner, couldn't exactly grow in a forest. Still, one sees natural influences in Domènech i Montaner's penchant for curves (rather than right angles) and plant- and animal-inspired flourishes.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A) Furthermore,

B) Similarly,

C) Of course,

D) Thus,

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

19 Transitions · Hard Key: A

In 2014, a team led by Morten Allentoft analyzed ancient DNA from 281 moa, the giant flightless birds that vanished from New Zealand after Polynesian settlement in the late thirteenth century. In all four species studied, the DNA revealed large populations whose genetic diversity held steady for the 4,000 years before the extinction; _____ people, not a prior decline, most likely drove the birds to extinction.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A) therefore,

B) similarly,

C) nevertheless,

D) meanwhile,

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

20 Command of Evidence · Easy Key: B

The Milky Way galaxy is composed of millions of stars in a relatively flat structure containing a thin disk and a thick disk. Based on computer simulations and analysis of data on the brightness, position, and chemical composition of about 250,000 stars in the thick disk (collected from two telescopes, one in China and one orbiting in space), astrophysicists Maosheng Xiang and Hans-Walter Rix claim that the thick disk of the Milky Way formed in two distinct phases rather than a single one.

Which finding, if true, would most directly support the researchers' claim?

A) The telescopes used by the researchers have detected stars of similar ages in galaxies other than the Milky Way.

B) There's an age difference of about 2 billion years between certain stars in the thick disk.

C) The thin disk contains about twice as many stars that can be seen from Earth as the thick disk does.

D) The stars in the Milky Way tend to have very similar chemical compositions.

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

21 Words in Context · Easy Key: D

The following text is from Mark Twain's 1876 novel The Adventures of Tom Sawyer. As a punishment, Tom's aunt has made him spend his Saturday whitewashing, or painting, a long fence.

Tom appeared on the sidewalk with a bucket of whitewash and a long-handled brush. He surveyed the fence, and all gladness left him and a deep melancholy settled down upon his spirit. Thirty yards of board fence nine feet high. Life to him seemed hollow, and existence but a burden.

As used in the text, what does the word "surveyed" most nearly mean?

A) Took a poll about

B) Drew a map of

C) Wrote a report on

D) Took a long look at

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

22 Boundaries · Medium Key: C

Psychologist Sapna Cheryan studies how physical settings signal who belongs in them. In one experiment, female students surveyed in a classroom containing a Star Trek poster, video game boxes, and other objects stereotypically linked to computer _____ reported less interest in the field than male students did, a gap that disappeared in a room with neutral objects.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A) science,

B) science;

C) science

D) science:

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

23 Boundaries · Medium Key: C

It is generally true that technological change is a linear process, in which once-useful technologies are replaced by new and better _____ the reawakening of interest in the steam engine (from advocates of carbon-neutral rail travel) reminds us that ostensibly obsolete technologies may be brought back into service to address society's changing needs.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A) ones, even so;

B) ones even so,

C) ones; even so,

D) ones, even so,

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

24 Inferences · Easy Key: C

Tomato flowers release their pollen only when they are vibrated, a process known as buzz pollination. Honeybees cannot vibrate flowers in this way, so greenhouse growers in many countries use bumblebees, which can. Bumblebees are not native to Australia, however, and growers there have instead vibrated each flower by hand with an electric wand. Entomologist Katja Hogendoorn and colleagues tested a native species, the blue-banded bee Amegilla chlorocyanea, in greenhouses. Tomatoes from flowers the bees visited freely weighed 21 percent more than tomatoes from wand-pollinated flowers, a result similar to those achieved with bumblebees. For Australian growers, the blue-banded bee may therefore _____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A) be less effective than honeybees at pollinating tomato flowers.

B) require growers to keep vibrating each flower with a wand after the bees have visited it.

C) offer a native alternative to bumblebees for pollinating greenhouse tomatoes.

D) become a more popular choice than bumblebees among tomato growers outside Australia.

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

25 Rhetorical Synthesis · Easy Key: D

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- The Azores is a group of islands about 870 miles off the coast of Portugal.
- Historians have long believed that in the fifteenth century Portuguese mariners were the first humans to populate the Azores.
- A 2015 study coauthored by Sofia Gabriel and Maria da Luz Mathias found that Vikings from Scandinavia may have populated the Azores as early as the ninth century.
- The researchers found a genetic connection between house mice in the Azores and house mice in Scandinavia.
- House mice may have traveled from Scandinavia to the Azores on Viking ships.

The student wants to specify who may have first populated the Azores, according to the 2015 study. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

A) Historians have long believed that the first humans to populate the Azores, a group of islands about 870 miles off the coast of Portugal, arrived in the fifteenth century.

B) Portuguese mariners may not have been the first humans to populate the Azores.

C) In their 2015 study, the researchers found a genetic connection between house mice in the Azores and those in Scandinavia.

D) According to a 2015 study, the first humans to populate the Azores may have been Vikings from Scandinavia, not mariners from Portugal as previously believed.

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

26 Inferences · Medium Key: A

Marine archaeologists have found much of the wooden hull of a sixteenth-century ship in a flooded quarry in southeast England. When it is exposed to air and water, wood rots quickly unless it is protected by sediment that shields it from oxygen. Therefore, the discovered ship was likely _____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A) covered by a protective sediment layer in the quarry.

B) one of several other ships buried in the same quarry.

C) a confirmation of previous theories about the type of wood that was used in sixteenth-century ships.

D) first constructed much earlier than previously thought.

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

27 Words in Context · Medium Key: B

The work of molecular biophysicist Enrique M. De La Cruz is known for _____ traditional boundaries between academic disciplines. The university laboratory that De La Cruz runs includes engineers, biologists, chemists, and physicists, and the research the lab produces makes use of insights and techniques from all those fields.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A) epitomizing

B) transcending

C) anticipating

D) reinforcing

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

28 Form, Structure, and Sense · Medium Key: C

Every last second of space shuttle mission STS-79, which lasted ten days and three hours, _____ carefully monitored by a team of experts.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A) have been

B) are

C) was

D) were

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

29 Boundaries · Medium Key: C

Archaeologists have estimated that the pre-Columbian Native American city of Cahokia, located across the Mississippi River from modern-day St. Louis, Missouri, had as many as 20,000 inhabitants in the year 1150 _____ it one of the largest cities in North America at the time.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A) CE making

B) CE. Making

C) CE, making

D) CE; making

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐ Seen before

Why:

30 Rhetorical Synthesis · Hard Key: C

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- Biofluorescence is the absorption of short wavelengths of light, such as ultraviolet, and their re-emission at longer wavelengths.
- Among mammals, it had been observed in the platypus, an egg-laying monotreme, and in marsupial opossums.
- It had also been seen in New World flying squirrels, which are placental mammals.
- A 2021 study by Erik Olson's team documented it in springhares, nocturnal African rodents.
- The springhares' fluorescence appears to derive partly from compounds in their hair called porphyrins.

The student wants to make and support a generalization about the mammals known to exhibit biofluorescence. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

A) The platypus, opossums, New World flying squirrels, and, as of 2021, African springhares have all been found to exhibit biofluorescence.

B) Mammals' biofluorescence derives from porphyrins in their hair, as the study of springhares by Olson's team shows.

C) Biofluorescence occurs across very different groups of mammals, as its presence in monotremes such as the platypus, marsupials such as opossums, and placental mammals such as flying squirrels shows.

D) Biofluorescence, the re-emission of absorbed light at longer wavelengths, has been observed in a variety of mammals.

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐ Seen before

Why:

31 Boundaries · Medium Key: A

Nine months before Rosa Parks made history by refusing to comply with the segregated seating policy on a Montgomery, Alabama, bus, a fifteen-year-old Montgomery girl named Claudette Colvin was arrested for the same _____ to some historians, Colvin's arrest led to Parks's action and eventually to the desegregation of Montgomery's bus system.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A) offense. According

B) offense, according

C) offense according

D) offense and according

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

32 Words in Context · Hard Key: B

Investigating whether shared false visual memories—specific but inaccurate and widely held recollections of images such as product logos—are caused by people's previous _____ incorrect renditions of the images, researchers Deepasri Prasad and Wilma Bainbridge found that, in fact, such memories are often not explained by familiarity with erroneous versions of the images.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A) compliance with

B) exposure to

C) criteria for

D) forfeiture of

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

33 Central Ideas and Details · Medium Key: D

Histories of science have often cast scholars of the medieval Islamic world as custodians who translated Greek texts and passed them on to Renaissance Europe largely unaltered. Historian George Saliba has challenged that portrayal. He documents how astronomers writing in Arabic identified problems in Ptolemy's account of planetary motion and proposed new models to resolve them. A geometric device introduced by Nasir al-Din al-Tusi in the thirteenth century and the planetary models of Ibn al-Shatir of Damascus in the fourteenth both closely resemble constructions that Copernicus used centuries later.

Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

A) Saliba argues that Copernicus concealed how much his work owed to astronomers who wrote in Arabic.

B) Saliba shows that Arabic translations of Greek astronomy were less faithful to their sources than historians had assumed.

C) Al-Tusi and Ibn al-Shatir used new observations to confirm that Ptolemy's account of planetary motion was accurate.

D) Saliba's research indicates that astronomers in the medieval Islamic world did original work rather than merely preserving Greek science.

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

34 Transitions · Medium Key: B

Because an achiral molecule is symmetrical, flipping it yields a structurally identical molecule. A flipped chiral molecule, _____ can be compared to a glove that has been turned inside out: it produces a structurally inverted molecule rather than an identical one.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A) in other words,

B) by contrast,

C) for example,

D) similarly,

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

35 Text Structure and Purpose · Hard

Key: C

The Museum of Broken Relationships originated in 2006 as an art project by Olinka Vištica and Dražen Grubišić, former partners who solicited objects left over from their friends' breakups and exhibited them in Zagreb, Croatia. Given a permanent home in Zagreb in 2010, the collection has continued to expand through donations from the public. Each item, frequently an object of no apparent value, is accompanied only by its donor's anonymous account of the relationship. The European Museum Forum awarded the museum its 2011 Kenneth Hudson Award, an honor reserved for achievements that challenge common perceptions of museums' role in society.

Which choice best states the main purpose of the text?

A) To explain how the breakup of the museum's founders inspired them to collect objects associated with failed relationships

B) To argue that museums should give the public a greater role in deciding which objects are collected and how they are labeled

C) To describe a museum of donated objects and anonymous stories that has been recognized for challenging ideas about museums

D) To identify the kinds of relationships that donors most often recall and the objects they typically choose to represent

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

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36 Rhetorical Synthesis · Easy

Key: A

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- Certhidea olivacea is a perching bird that can be found on the Galápagos Island of Pinzón.
- Creagrus furcatus is a seabird that can be found on the Galápagos Island of Darwin.
- Conservation organizations evaluate the risk that species will become extinct in the near future.
- C. olivacea faces a high risk of extinction.
- C. furcatus faces little risk of becoming extinct in the near future.

The student wants to compare the extinction risk faced by C. olivacea with that faced by C. furcatus. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

A) According to conservation organizations, C. olivacea has a higher risk of becoming extinct in the near future than C. furcatus.

B) C. furcatus faces a high risk of extinction, while C. olivacea faces little risk of becoming extinct in the near future.

C) Conservation organizations have evaluated both C. furcatus's and C. olivacea's risk of becoming extinct in the near future.

D) C. olivacea is a perching bird that faces a high risk of extinction.

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

37 Command of Evidence · Medium Key: C

Since 1958, the Modern Language Association (MLA) has periodically surveyed American colleges and universities about enrollments in languages other than English. Between the 2013 and 2016 censuses, total enrollments declined by more than 9 percent, and of the fifteen most commonly taught languages, only Japanese and Korean registered gains. Analyzing the 2016 census, Dennis Looney and Natalia Lusin observed that Korean's growth had carried it past three of those languages, advancing it to eleventh place in the rankings.

Fall Enrollments in Four Languages at US Colleges and Universities, 2006–2016

Language	2006	2009	2013	2016
Korean	7,146	8,449	12,256	13,936
Ancient Greek	22,842	21,515	16,961	13,264
Biblical Hebrew	14,137	13,764	12,596	9,587
Portuguese	10,310	11,273	12,407	9,827

Which choice best describes data from the table that support Looney and Lusin's claim?

A) Korean enrollments rose in every census year shown, from 7,146 in 2006 to 13,936 in 2016.

B) Enrollments in Ancient Greek fell in every census year shown, whereas enrollments in Portuguese rose until 2013 and then fell.

C) Korean enrollments were lower than those in Ancient Greek, Biblical Hebrew, and Portuguese in 2013 but higher than those in all three languages in 2016.

D) Korean enrollments had surpassed those in Biblical Hebrew and Portuguese by 2013 and then surpassed those in Ancient Greek by 2016.

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

38 Text Structure and Purpose · Easy Key: B

The following text is adapted from Jason Reynolds's 2016 novel Ghost. The narrator, who is in middle school, is at a bus stop.

I just go there [to the bus stop] to look at the people working out. See, the gym across the street has this big window—like the whole wall is a window—and they have those machines that make you feel like you walking up steps and so everybody just be facing the bus stop, looking all crazy like they're about to pass out. And trust me, there ain't nothing funnier than that. So I check that out for a little while like it's some kind of movie: The About to Pass Out Show, starring stair-stepper person one through ten.
©2016 by Jason Reynolds

Which choice best states the main purpose of the text?

A) To give a reason why the narrator is excited to start middle school

B) To describe an activity that the narrator finds amusing

C) To explain a problem that the narrator has overcome

D) To discuss a movie that the narrator saw in a theater

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

39 Inferences · Easy Key: A

In many cultures, a handshake can create trust between people. Engineer João Avelino and his team are designing a robot to shake hands with a human in order to improve human-robot interactions. The robot hand adjusts its movements and pressure to better imitate the feel of a human hand. The researchers want the robot's handshake to feel realistic because _____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A) lifelike handshakes may make people more comfortable interacting with robots.

B) it's easier to program a robot to perform handshakes than it is to program a robot to perform some other types of greetings.

C) people are less likely to interact with robots that don't look like humans.

D) the robot in the researchers' study may have uses other than interacting with humans.

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

40 Form, Structure, and Sense · Easy

Key: C

The alga species Chlorella vulgaris is very efficient at making oxygen. For this reason, scientists are currently exploring ways to use this species in space. C. vulgaris might be used, for example, to build future biological air exchange systems that _____ oxygen for astronauts.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A) are producing

B) produced

C) produce

D) have produced

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

41 Central Ideas and Details · Easy

Key: D

The following text is from Beatrice Harraden's 1894 novel Ships that Pass in the Night.

In an old second-hand bookshop in London, an old man sat reading Gibbon's History of Rome. He did not put down his book when the postman brought him a letter. He just glanced indifferently at the letter, and impatiently at the postman. Zerviah Holme did not like to be interrupted when he was reading Gibbon; and as he was always reading Gibbon, an interruption was always regarded by him as an insult.

Based on the text, how did Zerviah Holme most likely feel when the letter was delivered?

A) He felt relieved because he had been expecting an important letter.

B) He felt excited because the letter was from a good friend.

C) He felt sad because the postman did not stop to talk with him before leaving.

D) He felt annoyed because he was interrupted while reading his favorite author.

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

42 Text Structure and Purpose · Hard Key: D

Some studies have suggested that posture can influence cognition, but we should not overstate this phenomenon. A case in point: In a 2014 study, Megan O'Brien and Alaa Ahmed had subjects stand or sit while making risky simulated economic decisions. Standing is more physically unstable and cognitively demanding than sitting; accordingly, O'Brien and Ahmed hypothesized that standing subjects would display more risk aversion during the decision-making tasks than sitting subjects did, since they would want to avoid further feelings of discomfort and complicated risk evaluations. But O'Brien and Ahmed actually found no difference in the groups' performance.

Which choice best states the main purpose of the text?

A) It argues that research findings about the effects of posture on cognition are often misunderstood, as in the case of O'Brien and Ahmed's study.

B) It presents the study by O'Brien and Ahmed to critique the methods and results reported in previous studies of the effects of posture on cognition.

C) It explains a significant problem in the emerging understanding of posture's effects on cognition and how O'Brien and Ahmed tried to solve that problem.

D) It discusses the study by O'Brien and Ahmed to illustrate why caution is needed when making claims about the effects of posture on cognition.

Official ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5 **New** ☐ Seen before

Why:

43 Command of Evidence · Hard Key: A

Mycorrhizal fungi in soil benefits many plants, substantially increasing the mass of some. A student conducted an experiment to illustrate this effect. The student chose three plant species for the experiment, including two that are mycorrhizal hosts (species known to benefit from mycorrhizal fungi) and one nonmycorrhizal species (a species that doesn't benefit from and may even be harmed by mycorrhizal fungi). The student then grew several plants from each species both in soil containing mycorrhizal fungi and in soil that had been treated to kill mycorrhizal and other fungi. After several weeks, the student measured the plants' average mass and was surprised to discover that _____

Effects of Mycorrhizal Fungi on 3 Plant Species

Plant species	Mycorrhizal host	Average mass of plants grown in soil containing mycorrhizal fungi (in grams)	Average mass of plants grown in soil treated to kill fungi (in grams)
Corn	yes	15.1	3.8
Marigold	yes	10.2	2.4
Broccoli	no	7.5	7

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to complete the statement?

A) broccoli grown in soil containing mycorrhizal fungi had a slightly higher average mass than broccoli grown in soil that had been treated to kill fungi.

B) corn grown in soil containing mycorrhizal fungi had a higher average mass than broccoli grown in soil containing mycorrhizal fungi.

C) marigolds grown in soil containing mycorrhizal fungi had a much higher average mass than marigolds grown in soil that had been treated to kill fungi.

D) corn had the highest average mass of all three species grown in soil that had been treated to kill fungi, while marigolds had the lowest.

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

Part 2

44 Central Ideas and Details · Hard

Key: C

In 1577 a questionnaire designed by Juan López de Velasco, chief cosmographer of Spain's Council of the Indies, was sent to local officials in the Americas. López de Velasco intended to compile their answers into a comprehensive description of the Indies, and one question requested a map of each town depicting its streets, plazas, and other notable features. Many Spanish officials in New Spain, art historian Barbara Mundy has shown, wrote the textual answers themselves but delegated the maps to Indigenous painters. These painters represented their communities as pre-Hispanic manuscript painters had, using place-name glyphs, stylized trees, and trails of footprints to convey a community's history and social order rather than its topography.

What does the text most strongly suggest about the maps that Indigenous painters made in response to the questionnaire?

A) They likely recorded distances between communities more precisely than the maps that Spanish officials drew themselves.

B) They likely led López de Velasco to send out a revised questionnaire asking officials to draw the maps themselves.

C) They were likely of limited use for the comprehensive description of the Indies that López de Velasco intended to compile.

D) They likely reflected Spanish officials' instructions about which features of each community the painters should emphasize.

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

45 Boundaries · Hard

Key: D

Economist Trevon Logan has studied whether the Black officials who served during Reconstruction altered public finance in the US South. Because such officials may have won office precisely where voters already favored redistribution, Logan relied on an instrumental _____ number of free Black residents in each county in 1860, before emancipation—to estimate their effect on county tax revenue.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A) variable, the

B) variable: the

C) variable the

D) variable—the

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

46 Command of Evidence · Hard Key: B

To assess the impact of invasive species on ecosystems in Africa, Benis N. Egoh and colleagues reviewed government reports from those nations about how invasive species are undermining ecosystem services (aspects of the ecosystem on which residents depend). The services were sorted into three categories: provisioning (material resources from the ecosystem), regulating (natural processes such as cleaning the air or water), and cultural (nonmaterial benefits of ecosystems). Egoh and her team assert that countries in each region reported effects on provisioning services and that provisioning services represent the majority of the reported services.

Distribution of Ecosystem Services Affected by Invasive Species by Service Type

Region (Overall)	Provisioning (75%)	Regulating (21%)	Cultural (4%)
West	73%	27%	0%
North	88%	12%	0%
South	79%	14%	7%
East	83%	6%	11%
Central	33%	67%	0%

Which choice best describes data from the table that support Egoh and colleagues' assertion?

A) Provisioning services represent 73% of the services reported for the West region and 33% of those for the Central region, but they represent 75% of the services reported overall.

B) None of the percentages shown for provisioning services are lower than 33%, and the overall percentage shown for provisioning services is 75%.

C) Provisioning services are shown for each region, while no cultural services are shown for some regions.

D) The greatest percentage shown for provisioning services is 88% for the North region, and the least shown for provisioning services is 33% for the Central region.

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

47 Central Ideas and Details · Medium Key: B

The following text is adapted from Christina Rossetti's 1881 poem "Monna Innominata 2."

I wish I could remember that first day,
First hour, first moment of your meeting me,
If bright or dim the season, it might be
Summer or Winter for [all] I can say;
So unrecorded did it slip away,
So blind was I to see and to foresee,
So dull to mark the budding of my tree
That would not blossom yet for many a May.

Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

A) The speaker celebrates how the passage of time has strengthened a relationship that once seemed unimportant.

B) Because the speaker did not anticipate how important a relationship would become, she cannot recall how the relationship began, which she regrets.

C) As the anniversary of the beginning of an important relationship approaches, the speaker feels conflicted about how best to commemorate it.

D) After years of neglecting a once valuable relationship, the speaker worries it may be too late for her to salvage the relationship.

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

48 Boundaries · Medium Key: C

Wood is opaque partly because its cell walls contain lignin, a light-absorbing polymer. In 2016, researchers led by Lars Berglund at the KTH Royal Institute of Technology in Stockholm chemically removed the lignin from thin wood _____ they filled the remaining cellulose scaffold with an acrylic polymer whose refractive index matches that of cellulose, yielding transparent wood.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A) veneers, then,

B) veneers and

C) veneers;

D) veneers

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

49 Words in Context · Hard

Key: D

The following text is from Arnold Bennett's 1908 novel The Old Wives' Tale. Sophia keeps a boardinghouse in Paris during the 1870–71 siege of the city.

Sophia might have fed her flock without resorting to the official rations, but she would not sacrifice the economy which they represented. She demanded thick clothes for the concierge's boy, and received boots from Chirac, gloves from Carlier, and a great overcoat from Niepce. The weather increased in severity, and provisions in price.

As used in the text, what does the word "economy" most nearly mean?

A) Commerce

B) Simplicity

C) Management

D) Saving

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

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50 Form, Structure, and Sense · Medium

Key: D

Tambaqui, large fruit-eating fish of the Amazon basin, forage in seasonally flooded forests. Combining radiotelemetry of wild fish in Peru's Pacaya-Samiria National Reserve with feeding trials in captivity, ecologist Jill Anderson estimated in 2011 that tambaqui, which can retain ingested seeds for several days, _____ some seeds as far as 5.5 kilometers from the parent plant.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A) dispersing

B) to disperse

C) having dispersed

D) disperse

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

51 Text Structure and Purpose · Hard

Key: C

According to Indian economist and sociologist Radhakamal Mukerjee (1889–1968), the Eurocentric concepts that informed early twentieth-century social scientific methods—for example, the idea that all social relations are reducible to struggles between individuals—had little relevance for India. Making the social sciences more responsive to Indians' needs, Mukerjee argued, required constructing analytical categories informed by India's cultural and ecological circumstances. Mukerjee thus proposed the communalist "Indian village" as the ideal model on which to base Indian economic and social policy.

Which choice best describes the overall structure of the text?

A) The text recounts Mukerjee's early training in the social scientific disciplines and then lists social policies whose implementation Mukerjee oversaw.

B) The text mentions some of Mukerjee's economic theories and then traces their impact on other Indian social scientists of the twentieth century.

C) The text presents Mukerjee's critique of the social sciences and then provides an example of his attempts to address issues he identified in his critique.

D) The text explains an influential economic theory and then demonstrates how that theory was more important to Mukerjee's work than other social scientists have acknowledged.

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

52 Inferences · Hard

Key: C

The Pacific rat (Rattus exulans) reached New Zealand only by being transported by Polynesian voyagers; once introduced, these omnivorous rodents proliferated rapidly, leaving distinctive incisor marks on the hard seed cases of indigenous trees. Radiocarbon dates obtained in the 1990s on rat bones, some as early as about 200 BCE, therefore indicated human colonization more than a millennium before the earliest archaeological evidence of settlement, around 1280 CE. Paleoecologist Janet Wilmshurst and colleagues instead dated rat-gnawed seed cases from numerous deposits on both main islands. None predated about 1280, although ungnawed seeds from some of the same deposits were thousands of years old. These findings imply that _____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A) Pacific rats had reached New Zealand by about 200 BCE but did not begin feeding on the seeds of native trees until roughly 1280.

B) Polynesian voyagers had settled New Zealand by about 200 BCE but did not introduce the Pacific rat until roughly a millennium later.

C) the earlier dates on rat bones were most likely erroneous and people probably did not reach New Zealand until about 1280.

D) seed cases provide more reliable radiocarbon dates than bones do for the arrival of any animal species on a previously uninhabited island.

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

53 Cross-Text Connections · Medium Key: D

Text 1

Once the most abundant bird in North America, numbering perhaps three to five billion in the 1800s, the passenger pigeon was extinct by 1914. Sequencing most of its genome, a team led by Chih-Ming Hung calculated that its effective population size, a measure inferred from genetic diversity, had for the last million years been only about one ten-thousandth of that figure. The species, the team concluded, had likely gone through dramatic booms and busts that left it vulnerable to hunting.

Text 2

Theory predicts that larger populations retain more genetic diversity, so the passenger pigeon's strikingly low diversity is puzzling. Analyzing 41 mitochondrial and 4 nuclear genomes, Gemma Murray's team concluded that the bird's vast numbers let natural selection act with unusual efficiency, spreading beneficial mutations and purging harmful ones, which also erodes diversity in nearby stretches of the genome. The population, in their view, remained enormous and stable until hunting began.

Based on the texts, Hung's team (Text 1) and Murray's team (Text 2) would most likely agree with which statement about the passenger pigeon?

A) Its population rose and fell dramatically in the thousands of years before people began hunting it intensively.

B) Natural selection eliminated harmful mutations from its population faster than from the populations of other pigeon species.

C) Its extinction resulted mainly from a loss of genetic diversity that occurred during the 1800s.

D) Its genetic diversity was lower than the size of its population in the 1800s would lead one to expect.

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

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54 Form, Structure, and Sense · Hard Key: A

In assessing the films of Japanese director Akira Kurosawa, _____ have missed his equally deep engagement with Japanese artistic traditions such as Noh theater.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A) many critics have focused on Kurosawa's use of Western literary sources but

B) Kurosawa's use of Western literary sources has been the focus of many critics, who

C) there are many critics who have focused on Kurosawa's use of Western literary sources, but they

D) the focus of many critics has been on Kurosawa's use of Western literary sources; they

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

55 Transitions · Easy Key: B

Psychologist Asifa Majid and linguist Niclas Burenhult asked speakers of Jahai, a hunter-gatherer language of the Malay Peninsula, to name a series of odors. The Jahai speakers responded concisely and consistently, using abstract smell terms. _____ English speakers given the same odors offered long, varied descriptions, typically naming a likely source of the smell.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A) Similarly,

B) By contrast,

C) For instance,

D) Consequently,

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐ Seen before

Why:

56 Rhetorical Synthesis · Medium Key: D

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- The Oldowan artifacts from Gona, Ethiopia, dated to roughly 2.6 million years ago, were long considered the earliest stone tools.
- In 2015, archaeologist Sonia Harmand's team reported stone artifacts from Lomekwi 3, a site on the western shore of Kenya's Lake Turkana.
- Dated to 3.3 million years ago, the Lomekwian tools are much larger than Oldowan implements.
- They also predate the earliest known fossils of the genus Homo.

The student wants to emphasize the order in which the Gona tools and the Lomekwi 3 tools were made. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

A) The Lomekwian tools are much larger than the Oldowan artifacts from Gona.

B) In 2015, Harmand's team reported stone artifacts from Lomekwi 3, a site near Lake Turkana in Kenya.

C) According to Harmand's team, the Lomekwian tools predate the earliest known fossils of the genus Homo.

D) The Lomekwi 3 tools were made some 700,000 years before the Oldowan artifacts from Gona.

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐ Seen before

Why:

57 Transitions · Hard

Key: D

The Sun and other stars are powered by nuclear fusion reactions, in which two atoms collide to form a single heavier atom, releasing energy. Scientists have long believed that fusion has the potential to meet humanity's clean energy needs. _____ prior to December 2022, no fusion reaction in a laboratory setting had ever generated a net energy gain.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A) For this reason,

B) Moreover,

C) Specifically,

D) That said,

Official ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5 **New** ☐ Seen before

Why:

58 Transitions · Easy

Key: C

In June, female loggerhead sea turtles will swim back to the sandy beaches where they were born to lay eggs of their own. First, the turtle will dig her nest in the sand. _____ she will lay up to 100 eggs in the nest. Finally, she will cover it all with sand, before returning to the ocean.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A) By contrast,

B) Similarly,

C) Next,

D) For example,

Official ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5 **New** ☐ Seen before

Why:

59 Central Ideas and Details · Easy Key: D

The following text is adapted from Edmondo De Amicis's 1886 novel Cuore (translated by Isabel F. Hapgood in 1887). Enrico, a schoolboy in Turin, Italy, is starting a new school year.

The school seemed to me so small and gloomy when I thought of the woods and the mountains where I had passed the summer! I thought again, too, of my master in the second class, who was so good, and who always smiled at us, and was so small that he seemed to be one of us, and I grieved that I should no longer see him there, with his tumbled red hair. I said to myself: "This is my first day. There are nine months more. What toil, what monthly examinations, what fatigue!"

Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

A) Enrico is excited to begin school again because he has missed his classmates over the summer.

B) Enrico is worried that he will do poorly on his examinations because he did not study during the summer.

C) Enrico wishes he could spend the school year in the mountains with his former master.

D) Enrico feels gloomy about the new school year, missing both his summer and his old teacher.

Official ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5 **New** ☐ Seen before

Why:

60 Text Structure and Purpose · Hard Key: B

For much of the twentieth century, scholars of Hawai'i relied on a small canon of nineteenth-century Hawaiian writings that had been translated into English. M. Puakea Nogelmeier, a scholar of the Hawaiian language, traces this reliance to a "discourse of sufficiency": the long-standing acceptance of a fraction of the sources as adequate to represent the whole. Hawaiian-language newspapers alone, published from 1834 until 1948, filled some 125,000 pages with news, history, literature, and lore, much of which later scholars left untapped. Moreover, Nogelmeier argues, the translations themselves recast their authors' self-representations to fit a Western framework.

Which choice best describes the function of the underlined sentence in the text as a whole?

A) It presents evidence for the claim, made in the following sentence, that the translations distort how Hawaiian authors represented themselves.

B) It offers an example that conveys how much material the reliance described in the previous sentence has left out of consideration.

C) It explains why scholars came to treat a handful of translated works as an adequate basis for their research on Hawai'i.

D) It identifies the period during which the canonical translations described in the first sentence were first published in English.

Official ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5 **New** ☐ Seen before

Why:

61 Words in Context · Medium Key: D

Kiezdeutsch, a way of speaking that emerged among young people in multilingual urban neighborhoods, is often dismissed as broken German or as immigrants' failed attempt to speak the standard language. Linguist Heike Wiese contends, however, that its departures from standard German are _____, conforming to grammatical regularities typical of Germanic languages.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A) arbitrary

B) transitional

C) cosmetic

D) systematic

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

62 Form, Structure, and Sense · Hard Key: B

In a recent analysis of lyrical trends in 350,000 songs, researchers cite increases in certain measures, such as the ratio of choruses to verses, as evidence music lyrics are becoming more repetitive. For instance, from 1970 to 2020, _____ chorus-to-verse ratios trended similarly, with each genre's data indicating that relative to the number of unique verses, the number of repeated choruses in songs increased.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A) rocks and raps

B) rock's and rap's

C) rocks and rap's

D) rock and rap's

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

63 Cross-Text Connections · Hard Key: B

Text 1

Conventional wisdom long held that human social systems evolved in stages, beginning with hunter-gatherers forming small bands of members with roughly equal status. The shift to agriculture about 12,000 years ago sparked population growth that led to the emergence of groups with hierarchical structures: associations of clans first, then chiefdoms, and finally, bureaucratic states.

Text 2

In a 2021 book, anthropologist David Graeber and archaeologist David Wengrow maintain that humans have always been socially flexible, alternately forming systems based on hierarchy and collective ones with decentralized leadership. The authors point to evidence that as far back as 50,000 years ago some hunter-gatherers adjusted their social structures seasonally, at times dispersing in small groups but also assembling into communities that included esteemed individuals.

Based on the texts, how would Graeber and Wengrow (Text 2) most likely respond to the "conventional wisdom" presented in Text 1?

A) By conceding the importance of hierarchical systems but asserting the greater significance of decentralized collective societies

B) By disputing the idea that developments in social structures have followed a linear progression through distinct stages

C) By acknowledging that hierarchical roles likely weren't a part of social systems before the rise of agriculture

D) By challenging the assumption that groupings of hunter-gatherers were among the earliest forms of social structure

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

64 Command of Evidence · Hard Key: A

Since its founding in 1966, the Duke Lemur Center in North Carolina has accumulated detailed records on nearly 4,200 strepsirrhine primates—the group comprising lemurs, lorises, and galagos—with longitudinal observations that frequently span an animal's entire life. Drawing on these records, Sarah Zehr and colleagues compiled standardized life-history values, including adult body mass, gestation length, and activity pattern, for 27 taxa. Of the diurnal (day-active) taxa listed in the table, the one with the shortest expected gestation is the _____

Life-History Values for Five Strepsirrhine Taxa at the Duke Lemur Center

Taxon	Activity pattern	Mean adult body mass (grams)	Expected gestation length (days)
Gray mouse lemur	nocturnal	83	60
Northern giant mouse lemur	nocturnal	302	90
Eastern lesser bamboo lemur	diurnal	1,012	145
Ring-tailed lemur	diurnal	2,455	130
Red ruffed lemur	diurnal	3,601	98

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to complete the text?

A) red ruffed lemur, whose adults average about 3,600 grams.

B) gray mouse lemur, whose adults average about 80 grams.

C) eastern lesser bamboo lemur, whose adults average about 1,000 grams.

D) northern giant mouse lemur, whose adults average about 300 grams.

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

65 Rhetorical Synthesis · Medium Key: A

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- Muckrakers were journalists who sought to expose corruption in US institutions during the Progressive Era (1897–1920).
- Ida Tarbell was a muckraker who investigated the Standard Oil Company.
- She interviewed Standard Oil Company executives, oil industry workers, and public officials.
- She examined thousands of pages of the company's internal communications, including letters and financial records.
- Her book The History of the Standard Oil Company (1904) exposed the company's unfair business practices.

The student wants to emphasize the thoroughness of Ida Tarbell's investigation of the Standard Oil Company. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

A) Ida Tarbell not only interviewed Standard Oil executives, oil industry workers, and public officials but also examined thousands of pages of the company's internal communications.

B) Ida Tarbell, who investigated the Standard Oil Company, was a muckraker (a journalist who sought to expose corruption in US institutions during the Progressive Era, 1897–1920).

C) As part of her investigation of the Standard Oil Company, muckraker Ida Tarbell conducted interviews.

D) Published in 1904, muckraker Ida Tarbell's book The History of the Standard Oil Company exposed the company's unfair business practices.

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐ Seen before

Why:

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66 Words in Context · Hard Key: C

According to a US tax policy expert, state taxes are _____ other factors when considering an interstate move. Even significant differences in state taxation have almost no effect on most people's decisions, while differences in employment opportunities, housing availability, and climate are strong influences.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A) consistent with

B) representative of

C) overshadowed by

D) irrelevant to

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐ Seen before

Why:

67 Command of Evidence · Medium Key: D

It has been hypothesized that since birds can dissipate excess heat through their bills, bill size should increase with habitat temperature. To evaluate this hypothesis for a 2021 study, Charlotte Probst and colleagues gathered data on mean bill surface area of species of North American thrashers (genus: Toxostoma) as well as on climate conditions of the birds' native habitats. Based on their data, Probst and colleagues concluded that the hypothesis was not fully supported.

North American Thrasher Mean Bill Size and Habitat Temperature Range

Species	Mean bill surface area (cm^2)	Mean maximum temperature of warmest month (°C)	Mean minimum temperature of coldest month (°C)
Brown thrasher	1.86	30.40	–4.29
Bendire's thrasher	1.98	36.57	0.24
Long-billed thrasher	2.24	35.27	8.82
Cozumel thrasher	2.28	33.27	18.21
Ocellated thrasher	3.26	27.56	5.45

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to support Probst and colleagues' conclusion?

A) Although the Bendire's thrasher has one of the smallest mean bill surface areas of the birds included in the table, its habitat has one of the lowest mean maximum temperatures in the warmest month and one of the lowest mean minimum temperatures in the coldest month.

B) Although the Cozumel thrasher has the second greatest mean bill surface area of the birds included in the table, its habitat's mean temperature in the warmest month is significantly higher than that of the other birds' habitats.

C) Of the birds included in the table, the brown thrasher has the smallest mean bill surface area and the habitat with the lowest mean minimum temperature in the coldest month, while the long-billed thrasher has the second-largest mean bill surface area and the habitat with the second-highest mean minimum temperature in the coldest month.

D) Of the birds included in the table, the ocellated thrasher has the largest mean bill surface area and the habitat with the lowest mean maximum temperature in the warmest month, while the Bendire's thrasher has the second smallest mean bill surface area and the habitat with the highest mean maximum temperature in the warmest month.

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

68 Boundaries · Easy Key: B

Robin Wall Kimmerer of the Citizen Potawatomi Nation is a bryologist, a plant scientist who specializes in mosses. To Kimmerer, mosses are Earth's most adaptable plants: they can clone _____ enter a dormant state in times of drought, and grow in areas that don't have soil.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A) themselves;

B) themselves,

C) themselves. And

D) themselves

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐ Seen before

Why:

69 Inferences · Medium Key: A

Along exposed Atlantic coastlines, boulders weighing many tonnes sometimes lie stranded on cliff tops far above the high-water mark. Because only exceptionally powerful waves could have emplaced such boulders, researchers have interpreted comparable deposits in several locations as evidence of past tsunamis. Geologist Rónadh Cox and colleagues compared photographs of coastal boulder deposits in western Ireland taken before and after the winter of 2013–2014, a season of severe Atlantic storms during which no tsunami reached the coast. Eighteen boulders weighing more than 50 tonnes had been displaced, the largest weighing roughly 620 tonnes, and some boulders had been transported at elevations as high as 29 meters above high water. Cox and her colleagues concluded that _____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A) storm waves are capable of moving boulders as massive as some that have been attributed to tsunamis.

B) the displaced boulders had most likely been moved by a small tsunami that went unrecorded during the winter of 2013–2014.

C) tsunamis are less capable than storm waves of moving large boulders onto cliff tops.

D) boulders on the west coast of Ireland are generally larger than those on other exposed Atlantic coastlines.

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐ Seen before

Why:

70 Rhetorical Synthesis · Hard Key: A

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- Freddie Wong (born 1985) is a director and special effects artist from the United States.
- He is best known for the action-comedy web series Video Game High School (VGHS).
- VGHS premiered in 2012 on RocketJump, a YouTube channel that Wong cocreated.
- The series was celebrated for its inventive video game–centric world and high-quality special effects.
- VGHS was nominated for a Producers Guild Award for Outstanding Digital Series.

The student wants to begin a narrative about Wong's award-nominated web series. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

A) In 2012, director and visual effects artist Freddie Wong launched a new action-comedy web series: Video Game High School.

B) Video Game High School was celebrated for its inventive video game–centric world and high-quality special effects, and it was nominated for a Producer's Guild Award for Outstanding Digital Series.

C) Wong, cocreator of the YouTube channel RocketJump, would go on to see his web series be nominated for a Producers Guild Award.

D) In 2012, Video Game High School premiered on RocketJump; it would later be nominated for an award.

Official ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5 **New** ☐ Seen before

Why:

71 Central Ideas and Details · Hard Key: C

The following text is Lizette Woodworth Reese's 1899 poem "Tears." The ancient Greek poet Homer was traditionally said to be blind, and in the Bible, King David mourns the death of his infant son.

When I consider Life and its few years—
A wisp of fog betwixt us and the sun;
A call to battle, and the battle done
Ere the last echo dies within our ears;
A rose choked in the grass; an hour of fears;
The gusts that past a darkening shore do beat;
The burst of music down an unlistening street,—
I wonder at the idleness of tears.
Ye old, old dead, and ye of yesternight,
Chieftains, and bards, and keepers of the sheep,
By every cup of sorrow that you had,
Loose me from tears, and make me see aright
How each hath back what once he stayed to weep:
Homer his sight, David his little lad!

Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

A) The speaker laments that even celebrated figures such as Homer and David endured losses that no achievement could repair.

B) The speaker suggests that the sorrows endured by people in ancient times were greater than those of the recently dead.

C) Because life is brief and the dead have regained what they once grieved for, the speaker regards weeping as pointless and asks to be freed from it.

D) Although the speaker at first considers tears useless, recalling the grief of Homer and David convinces the speaker that sorrow gives life meaning.

Official ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5 **New** ☐ Seen before

Why:

72 Central Ideas and Details · Hard Key: B

In their 2022 paper, Christos Dimopoulos et al., having granted that the existence of antigravity—in which antimatter and matter repel rather than attract each other—lacked affirmative experimental support, rightly argued that such antigravity was worth considering on theoretical grounds given that evidence against it was similarly lacking. But a 2023 report by an international team of researchers details the first direct ballistic observations of antihydrogen atoms under gravity inside a CERN particle accelerator. Corresponding most closely to predictions under gravitational attraction, these observations were thoroughly inconsistent with antigravity.

Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

A) Antihydrogen ballistics observations were conducted at CERN to test specific conclusions about antigravity presented in the 2022 paper by Dimopoulos et al.

B) Although theoreticians were justified in studying antigravity before the release of the 2023 report, the report's findings suggest that the rationale for theoretical consideration offered in the 2022 paper by Dimopoulos et al. is no longer applicable.

C) The theoretical approach represented in the 2022 paper by Dimopoulos et al. assumed that unambiguous proof of antigravity would not be achievable, but the results in the 2023 report undermine that assumption.

D) Before 2023, researchers' inordinate focus on theoretical considerations hindered the development of the experimental regimen for direct antihydrogen ballistics observations.

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

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73 Form, Structure, and Sense · Medium Key: B

For the first Chicago Architecture Biennial in 2015, Mexican architect Tatiana Bilbao built a full-scale prototype of a house for low-income families. Its rigid core of concrete blocks is surrounded by lightweight modules made of wooden pallets, a combination that _____ residents to expand the dwelling in phases while its exterior always looks finished.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A) allow

B) allows

C) are allowing

D) have allowed

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

74 Cross-Text Connections · Easy Key: A

Text 1

Some animal species, like the leopard, can be found in many kinds of areas. On the other hand, tropical mountain bird species tend to be limited in the types of spaces they can call home. This is because many mountain bird species are only able to survive at very specific elevations. Over time, these species have likely become used to living at a specific temperature. Therefore, these species struggle to survive at elevations that are warmer or colder than they are used to.

Text 2

A new study reviewed observations of nearly 3,000 bird species to understand why tropical mountain bird species live at specific elevations. They noted that when a mountain bird species was found in an area with many other bird species, it tended to inhabit much smaller geographic areas. It is thus likely that competition for resources with other species, not temperature, limits where these birds can live.

Based on the texts, both authors would most likely agree with which statement?

A) Tropical mountain bird species are restricted in where they can live.

B) Scientists have better tools to observe tropical mountain birds than they did in the past.

C) Little is known about how tropical mountain birds build their nests.

D) Tropical mountain bird species that live at high elevations tend to be genetically similar.

Official ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5 **New** ☐ Seen before

Why:

75 Cross-Text Connections · Easy Key: A

Text 1

Global poverty statistics are most often reported as counts of people whose income or spending falls below an international poverty line. This threshold, set by the World Bank, is expressed as a fixed amount of money per person per day. The approach has clear strengths. A single money-based measure can be derived from household surveys and compared across countries and decades, allowing analysts to track whether the share of people living in extreme poverty is shrinking.

Text 2

Economist Sabina Alkire, director of the Oxford Poverty and Human Development Initiative, regards income as just one dimension of deprivation. The Multidimensional Poverty Index that she and Maria Emma Santos introduced in 2010 instead records whether households lack schooling, adequate nutrition, clean drinking water, electricity, and other necessities. The results can differ sharply from income-based figures: in Niger, about two-thirds of the population was income poor, but 93 percent was poor by the index's measure.

Based on the texts, how would Alkire (Text 2) most likely regard the approach to measuring poverty described in Text 1?

A) As incomplete, because a monetary threshold can fail to register many of the hardships that poor households actually experience

B) As outdated, because the poverty line it relies on has not been adjusted to reflect rising prices

C) As overly broad, because it classifies as poor many people whose basic needs are adequately met

D) As impractical, because household surveys are too costly to conduct regularly in many countries

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

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76 Words in Context · Hard Key: B

Vietnamese packs considerably more information into an average syllable than Basque does, yet when linguist Christophe Coupé and colleagues compared recordings of speakers of seventeen languages, they found that speech rate tends to _____ such differences in information density. Languages whose syllables carry relatively little information, such as Spanish, were spoken faster than those with information-dense syllables, and all seventeen conveyed information at roughly the same rate.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A) amplify

B) offset

C) outpace

D) dictate

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

77 Inferences · Medium Key: B

Ana Castillo's 1986 novel The Mixquiahuala Letters is a story told entirely through expressive letters from the narrator to her friend—letters that Castillo suggests could be read in several different orders. As they began reading it in class, some students remarked that they found the novel's letter format daunting and its treatment of gender relations old-fashioned. The professor, however, pointed out that the novel is written in modern-sounding language and addresses issues that still matter today, suggesting that The Mixquiahuala Letters _____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A) has more to say about gender relations than other novels from the same period.

B) is more relevant to contemporary audiences than it may seem at first.

C) is easier to read than many contemporary novels that focus on friendship.

D) is best understood after multiple readings in different orders.

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

78 Rhetorical Synthesis · Hard Key: B

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- In Mendez v. Westminster (1947), five Mexican American fathers challenged the segregation of their children into separate "Mexican schools" in Orange County, California.
- A federal appeals court ruled that this forced segregation was unconstitutional.
- In Hernandez v. Texas (1954), lawyers for agricultural worker Pete Hernandez challenged the exclusion of Mexican Americans from juries in Jackson County, Texas.
- No person with a Mexican or Latin American name had served on a jury there in twenty-five years.
- The US Supreme Court ruled unanimously that the Fourteenth Amendment's guarantee of equal protection extends to Mexican Americans.

The student wants to contrast the forms of discrimination challenged in the two cases. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

A) Mendez v. Westminster was decided by a federal appeals court in 1947, while Hernandez v. Texas went before the US Supreme Court in 1954.

B) Whereas the Mendez case challenged the segregation of Mexican American children in schools, the Hernandez case challenged the exclusion of Mexican Americans from juries.

C) Both Mendez v. Westminster and Hernandez v. Texas ended in rulings against discrimination directed at Mexican Americans.

D) In Hernandez v. Texas, lawyers for agricultural worker Pete Hernandez showed that no person with a Mexican or Latin American name had served on a jury in Jackson County in twenty-five years.

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

79 Boundaries · Easy Key: B

Earlier observations had found signs of hydration on the Moon's sunlit surface, but the data could not establish whether that hydration took the form of water or of hydroxyl, a related molecule. How _____ In 2020, a team led by Casey Honniball used the airborne telescope SOFIA to detect light at a wavelength unique to water molecules.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A) researchers could tell the two apart?

B) could researchers tell the two apart?

C) could researchers tell the two apart.

D) researchers could tell the two apart.

Official ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5 **New** ☐ Seen before

Why:

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80 Transitions · Hard Key: B

Malian singer Oumou Sangaré built her sound on wassoulou, a style rooted in the pentatonic songs of her mother's home region in southern Mali and anchored by the kamalengoni, a harp derived from the instrument played by Wassoulou hunters. Her lyrics, _____ have challenged social conventions long accepted there: her 1989 debut album, Moussolou ("Women"), warned listeners against polygamy and forced marriage.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A) therefore,

B) though,

C) for instance,

D) likewise,

Official ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5 **New** ☐ Seen before

Why:

81 Inferences · Hard Key: A

Several widely cited studies reported that the seawater acidity projected for the end of this century would profoundly impair the behavior of coral reef fishes, even leaving some fish attracted to the chemical cues of predators. Timothy Clark and colleagues, however, found negligible effects of such acidity on predator-cue avoidance, activity levels, and lateralization (a preference for turning left or right). Their data simulations also indicated that the large effects reported earlier were highly improbable, suggesting that _____.

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A) the behavioral impairments described in the earlier studies are unlikely to be a major consequence of ocean acidification for coral reef fishes.

B) the lateralization of coral reef fishes is more sensitive to increased acidity than is their avoidance of the chemical cues of predators.

C) coral reef fishes will become steadily more vulnerable to predators as the acidity of the seawater around them increases.

D) ocean acidification is unlikely to harm the corals on which many coral reef fishes depend for food and shelter.

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

82 Transitions · Medium Key: A

In most animals, a beating heart moves blood and oxygen through the body. The hearts of sea spiders, _____ are so feeble that they propel fluid only within the central body; in a 2017 study of twelve species, biologist H. Arthur Woods and colleagues determined that oxygen reaches the animals' spindly legs chiefly through peristaltic contractions of gut branches extending into each leg.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A) however,

B) therefore,

C) moreover,

D) in other words,

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

83 Command of Evidence · Hard Key: D

In the "language nest" model of education, Indigenous children learn the language of their people by using it as the medium of instruction and socialization at pre-K or elementary levels. In their 2016 study of a school in an Anishinaabe community in Ontario, Canada, scholars Lindsay Morcom and Stephanie Roy (who are Anishinaabe themselves) found that the model not only imparted fluency in the Anishinaabe language but also enhanced students' pride in Anishinaabe culture overall. Given these positive effects, Morcom and Roy predict that the model increases the probability that as adults, former students of the school will transmit the language to younger generations in their community.

Which finding, if true, would most strongly support the researchers' prediction?

A) Anishinaabe adults who didn't attend the school feel roughly the same degree of cultural pride as the former students of the school feel.

B) After transferring to the school, new students experience an increase in both fluency and academic performance overall.

C) As adults, former students of the school are just as likely to continue living in their community as individuals who didn't attend the school.

D) As they complete secondary and higher education, former students of the school experience no loss of fluency or cultural pride.

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

84 Cross-Text Connections · Medium Key: B

Text 1

It seems clear that emotional contagion (the unintentional transfer of an emotional state from one person to another) requires physical interaction and the observation of body language. After all, research shows that talking to someone who is smiling and expressing positive feelings often causes people to respond in a comparably positive way. Similarly, displays of nervous fidgeting have been found to prompt others to begin behaving more nervously, too.

Text 2

In an experiment using a social networking service, Zeyao Yang and Emilio Ferrara found evidence of emotional contagion in text-based online interactions. The researchers discovered that reading social media posts that expressed a positive outlook led people to make more positive posts themselves, while posts with a negative emotional tone led people to make more negative posts.

Based on the texts, what would the researchers in Text 2 most likely say about the claim underlined in Text 1?

A) It perpetuates a flawed understanding of emotional contagion, because there isn't enough evidence to suggest that smiling is a sign of emotional contagion.

B) It reflects an incomplete view of emotional contagion, because this phenomenon can occur even without in-person interaction.

C) It's fairly persuasive, because studies attempting to identify emotional contagion in situations without in-person interaction have thus far yielded unclear results.

D) It's mostly accurate, because the social networking study confirmed that emotional contagion primarily occurs in response to negative emotions like nervousness.

Official ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 **New** ☐Seen before

Why:

85 Command of Evidence · Easy Key: B

The Wonderful Adventures of Nils is a 1906 novel by Selma Lagerlöf, translated in 1907 by Velma Swanston Howard. In the novel, the narrator suggests that Nils's parents, farmers in southern Sweden, have improved their situation through their own diligence: _____

Which quotation from The Wonderful Adventures of Nils most effectively illustrates the claim?

A) "Things had turned out very well for them; and they would have gone to church that beautiful morning—satisfied and happy—if they hadn't had their son to think of."

B) "When they first moved there, the place couldn't feed more than one pig and a pair of chickens; but they were uncommonly industrious and capable folk—and now they had both cows and geese."

C) "His mother owned a great, heavy, iron-bound oak chest, which she permitted no one but herself to open. Here she treasured all the things she had inherited from her mother, and of these she was especially careful."

D) "Father complained that he was dull and lazy; he had not cared to learn anything at school, and he was such an all-round good-for-nothing, that he could barely be made to tend geese."

Official ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5 **New** ☐ Seen before

Why:

Answer grid

Official or new: 1 to 5. Seen: tick.

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